

CASE ID: 202308710002

EPISODE NAME: US Taiwan Arm Sales Fall 2023

2023/08/25 - Ongoing

Sender: China (710)

Target: United States (2)

Issue: End Weapons/Materials Proliferation (9)

Final Outcome: Ongoing

Narrative:

On 2023/08/25, China threatened the United States after the Biden administration approved a \$500 million arms sale to Taiwan, calling the sale “gross interference” in China’s internal affairs.¹² Beijing also sent ships and aircraft across the sensitive median line of the Taiwan Strait on 2023/08/26.³

The arms package to Taiwan, approved on 2023/08/23, consisted of advanced missile systems, fighter jets, and other military equipment.⁴ These arms sales, valued at billions of dollars, were intended to enhance Taiwan's defensive capabilities in the face of increasing military pressure from China.⁵

After the U.S. moved forward with the deal, China sanctioned US defense contractors Northrop Grumman Corp. and a subsidiary of Lockheed Martin Corp on 2023/09/15.⁶ The sanctions were symbolic, as neither corporation had any business interests subject to Chinese sanctions.⁷

These sanctions are still in effect, but have not deterred the U.S. from further arms sales to Taiwan.

¹ “China sends aircraft and vessels toward Taiwan days after US approves \$500-million arms sale.” El Pais, August 26, 2023.
<https://english.elpais.com/international/2023-08-26/china-sends-aircraft-and-vessels-toward-taiwan-days-after-us-ap-proves-500-million-arms-sale.html>

² Matthew Lee 2023. “US approves new \$500M arms sale to Taiwan as tension from China intensifies,” *AP*, August 23, 2023,
<https://apnews.com/article/us-taiwan-china-invasion-threat-weapons-sales-military-fb9959dff57d5ac8fd2f84003161>

³ “China sends aircraft and vessels toward Taiwan days after US approves \$500-million arms sale.” El Pais, August 26, 2023.
<https://english.elpais.com/international/2023-08-26/china-sends-aircraft-and-vessels-toward-taiwan-days-after-us-ap-proves-500-million-arms-sale.html>

⁴ *Ibid.*

⁵ *Ibid.*

⁶ “China Hits Two US Military Firms With Symbolic Moves Over Taiwan.” *Bloomberg*, 15 September 2023.
<https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2023-09-15/china-sanctions-two-us-military-firms-over-taiwan-arms-sale>

⁸

⁷ *Ibid.*